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SLO2 - Identifying and Solving a Problem

Introduction

A problem we identified while reviewing our project was that the UI we were using felt unappealing to both developers and users testing the product. There were several issues, such as difficulty navigating between pages, understanding what different parts of the UI were meant to do, and a color scheme that became an eyesore for users.

These issues went beyond just appearance. From a usability standpoint, the interface made it harder for users to complete tasks efficiently and understand how the application worked. From a social standpoint, the design made the product feel less professional and less trustworthy compared to similar applications, which affected how users perceived and interacted with it. In addition, there were concerns related to data safety and financial welfare. A poorly designed interface can make it unclear how user data is being handled or protected, which may lead to hesitation in using the system or sharing sensitive information. Similarly, if users are unsure about financial-related features such as stock prices they may lose confidence in the product, potentially leading to mistakes or avoidance of key features altogether.

Problem

The main problem was to redesign the UI in a way that improved usability and visual appeal without removing or overcomplicating the core features of the application. We also needed to consider users with different levels of experience, making sure the design was intuitive for new users while still being effective for more experienced ones.

Considerations

While looking to tackle these problems, we knew there were several things we needed to consider before creating a new design. A major focus was usability, making sure users could navigate the application easily, understand what different elements do, and complete tasks without unnecessary effort. We wanted to reduce confusion and make the interface feel more intuitive through clear visual cues and familiar design patterns.

Another important consideration was the overall look and feel of the application. From a social perspective, we wanted the design to feel clean, professional, and comparable to other applications users are familiar with. Keeping the page simple and visually consistent was important so that users would feel more comfortable using the product and have more confidence in it.

As a team, we thought if we worked towards a new design with these considerations in mind we would come to an intuitive design that wouldn't frustrate users as they browsed our application. The goal was to have a user naturally understand the functionality in our site. However we also wanted to provide ways for the user to learn more about aspects of the site if things weren't immediately intuitive.

Influences on design

Several factors influenced our design. The primary influences were our personal experience, the product owner, products providing a similar service, and feedback from user testing. As we developed, we would continuously find feedback about our design to see what we could improve. Much of this feedback told us that we had a poor user experience for the front-end portion of the product. Describing it as “unintuitive”, “unappealing”, and saying it “could use some work”. After we had collected feedback, we started looking for a new design for our application.

There were many options to consider when solving this problem. The initial one we wanted to tackle was the color scheme of the product. We initially used a golden yellow and brown for the application (Figure 1). The first decision we wanted to make was if we wanted our application to be forced into a light mode or dark mode. We considered using one or the other as well as providing users the ability to swap between the two. The next thing we listed out were the options for colors we considered. Our decision was to choose between a soft blue, a soft green, or a violet purple.

We went between these choices as blue provides a calm professional tone. The idea here was to use color to help gain the trust of the user. A green palette was considered because of its relation to growth and finance. Finally the violet was considered as a unique modern approach, but raised concern about user readability.

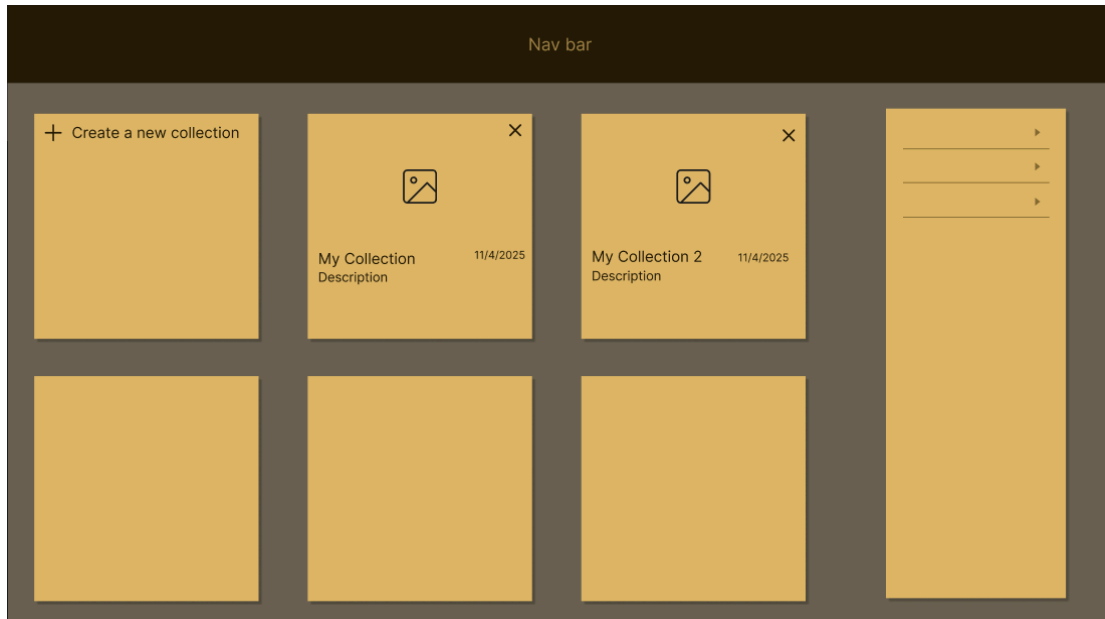


Figure 1. Original Color Scheme

Another option that needed to be decided on was how our group wanted to make the product become more usable for users. We listed out the options we had available to help provide users with a better experience with our application. These became constraining the view of the page to have users require fewer clicks to navigate to what they were looking for, providing more information in a smaller space, and splitting features into clearer identities inside of the application.

Solution

Our solution to improve the project focused on both usability and overall visual appeal. We adjusted the color scheme to primarily green and implemented both a dark and light mode (Figure 2). From a usability standpoint, this gave users more control over how they view the application and improved readability in different environments.

From a social standpoint, the updated color scheme created a more professional and visually consistent design that better aligns with similar applications. Allowing users to switch between dark and light modes also different user preferences, which contributed to more positive feedback.

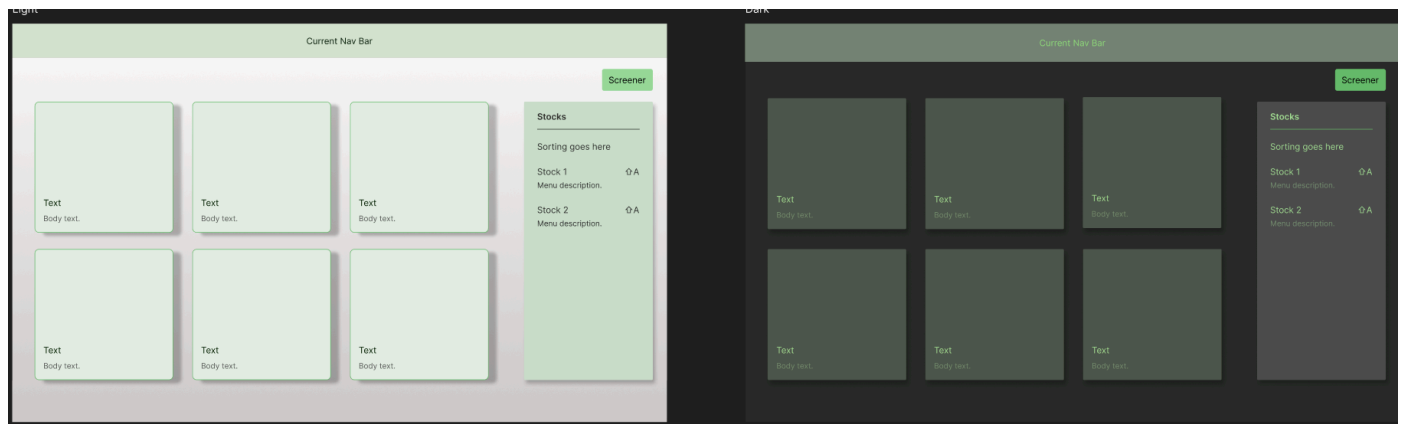


Figure 2. Light and Dark Mode

To address navigation and usability issues, we reduced the amount of unnecessary navigation and focused more on the core functionality of the application. We expanded the amount of information available on a single page while reducing the number of interactions required to complete tasks. From a usability perspective, this made it easier for users to find what they were looking for and complete actions more efficiently.

One of the most noticeable changes was removing the original landing page. Instead of landing on a card view of collections, users are now taken directly to the screener page. We also allowed users to save and switch between screeners on the same page, removing the need to navigate away. These changes reduced the number of steps required to perform common tasks and made the workflow more straightforward.

In addition to these improvements, we considered factors related to data safety and financial welfare. We designed the interface in a way that makes important information more transparent and easier to understand, helping users feel more confident about how their data is being handled. Clear labeling, consistent layouts, and added guidance reduce the likelihood of confusion when interacting with sensitive features. For financial-related aspects, such as interpreting market data or using screeners, we focused on presenting information in a straightforward and readable way. This helps users make more informed decisions and reduces the risk of misinterpretation or mistakes that could have financial consequences.

We added other useful things for the users as well, some of these include info bubbles on what different filters and columns are, a help page for users to learn more, and some simplified columns for those who know less about the market. We made these changes to try and give users an easier time working with our site while maintaining the core ideas behind our application.

Symbol	Price	Outstanding Shares
A	\$120.73	282,602,317
AA	\$66.75	263,862,592
AAA	\$24.99	N/A
AAAA	\$29.02	N/A
AAAC	\$20.02	N/A
AAAU	\$47.32	N/A
AACB	\$10.37	22,175,000
AACBR	\$0.30	N/A
AACBU	\$10.53	25,175,000
AACG	\$1.01	31,772,461
AACI	\$9.90	25,522,000
AACIU	\$10.01	N/A

13,233 results

Figure 3. What Users Are Greeted with

This design provided users with all the information directly in front of them with the ability to learn more about everything going on in an intuitive and aesthetically pleasing way. Gathering feedback about our solution told us that users found the new design to be visually appealing, drawing increased support and desire to use the app. The usability of our app also increased as everything was easily discoverable from the home page allowing users to find what they were looking for quickly. Users had an easier time navigating the application, taking less time to do tasks asked of them.

Overall, these changes resulted in a design that presents information more clearly and makes key features easier to access. Feedback showed that users found the new design more visually appealing and easier to use. Users were able to complete tasks more quickly and navigate the application with less confusion. This indicates that

the redesign successfully addressed the original usability and perception issues while maintaining the core functionality of the application.